

# Conversation

# #22

## CONVERSATION

### SHARED EXPENSES & FINANCIAL DECISIONS – *MONEY AND FRIENDSHIP*

Prepare 8 pieces of paper numbered from 1 to 8 and have each student draw one to discover their character.

This activity focuses on **money conversations, boundaries, negotiation, and emotional control**.

It's **Sunday evening** in **São Paulo**.

A group of friends shares an apartment or frequently spends time together.

At the end of the month, **expenses are higher than expected**, and someone noticed that payments are unbalanced.

Bills, subscriptions, food, and shared services created tension.

What starts as a practical conversation quickly becomes emotional.

The group must decide **how to split costs fairly** and avoid future conflicts.

#### Monthly Expense Overview (Shared in the Group Chat)

| Expense               | Total     | Notes                      |
|-----------------------|-----------|----------------------------|
| Rent                  | R\$ 4,800 | Split unevenly             |
| Electricity           | R\$ 420   | AC usage increased         |
| Internet & streaming  | R\$ 350   | Multiple subscriptions     |
| Groceries             | R\$ 1,200 | Not everyone shops equally |
| Delivery & eating out | R\$ 980   | Mostly weekends            |

#### Student Coaching – How to Use the Information

- Defend your position using **fairness, usage, or income**
- Say **yes** or **no** to expenses politely
- Suggest rules for future payments
- Remember: money conversations are emotional

#### Characters

##### 1. Alex – The Responsible One

"I track expenses and pay on time. Seeing this imbalance makes me uncomfortable.

I don't want conflict, but I want fairness. Ignoring this will only make it worse.

We need clear rules."

## **2. Rachel – The Emotional One**

“Talking about money stresses me out.  
I feel judged, even when I try my best.  
I don’t want to feel like a burden. But I also don’t want constant tension.  
This conversation hurts.”

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## **3. Mike – The Carefree One**

“I don’t think everything needs to be so strict. We’re friends, not business partners.  
Splitting every cent kills the vibe. I prefer flexibility.  
I don’t see the problem.”

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## **4. Emily – The Budget Planner**

“I plan my finances carefully. Unexpected expenses throw everything off.  
I’m not against sharing costs. I just need predictability.  
Surprises don’t work for me.”

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## **5. Kevin – The High User**

“I know I use more electricity and delivery apps. I’m not proud of it, but it’s my routine.  
I don’t want to feel attacked. If I pay more, I want that to be clear.  
Let’s be honest.”

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## **6. Laura – The Idealist**

“Money shouldn’t ruin friendships.  
I believe generosity matters.  
Sometimes helping each other is more important than fairness. But I know that has limits.  
I’m conflicted.”

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## **7. Daniel – The Income-Different Friend**

“My income is lower than everyone else’s. I don’t like bringing that up.  
Equal splits aren’t always equal. I need understanding, not pity.  
This is hard to say.”

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## **8. Olivia – The Mediator**

“Money conversations get ugly fast. If we don’t structure this, feelings will explode.  
We need rules everyone agrees on. Not perfect — just clear.  
I’ll help organize the solution.”

**Title:** \_\_\_\_\_